Writing Technique

Year 4 · **Homework Worksheet**

Worked Example

Worked example: Identify the technique: "Five fat frogs found a flower."

Answer: Alliteration — the repeated 'f' sound at the start of nearby words.

Easy / Standard (15 questions)

1. Which technique is used in "The leaves rustled and whispered in the breeze"? A) simile B) metaphor C) personification D) onomatopoeia
2. What technique uses 'like' or 'as' to compare two things? Give an example.
3. Identify the technique: "Five fat frogs found a flower."
4. Which sentence uses a simile? A) The ice was a frozen lake of glass. B) The ice was as smooth as glass. C) The ice glistened brightly. D) The ice cracked loudly.
5. Write a simile to describe a fast car.
6. What technique is used in "The kettle hissed and whistled"? Explain why the writer chose these words.
7. Underline the powerful verb and explain why it's better than 'looked': "She glared at her little brother."
8. Which sentence is an example of alliteration? A) Wild winds whipped wildly. B) The dog barked once. C) The sky was blue. D) She walked home.
9. Select ALL the sentences that use personification: A) The clock ticked loudly. B) The flowers bowed their heads in the rain. C) The moon watched over the sleeping town. D) The car engine started.
10. Choose the better-written sentence and explain why: A) "The fire was bright." B) "Golden flames licked greedily at the logs."
11. What technique is used in "The dog woofed and yipped excitedly"? Name it.
12. Write a metaphor to describe a kind teacher.
13. Which sentence begins with an adverb for variety? A) Suddenly, the lights went out. B) The lights went out suddenly. C) The lights went out. D) They went out, the lights.
14. Identify the technique used in this sentence: "The old clock tower watched over the town."
15. Select ALL the words below that are powerful verbs rather than plain, overused ones: A) ran B) dashed C) got D) snatched

Standard (15 questions)

1. What is the difference between personification and a metaphor? Give one example of each.
2. Which sentence uses a metaphor (not a simile)? A) Her smile was as bright as sunshine. B) Her smile was sunshine itself. C) Her smile seemed like sunshine. D) Her smile shone like sunshine.
3. Identify the technique and explain its effect: "The gate creaked open slowly."
4. Rewrite this sentence to include a powerful verb instead of 'said': "\"Help me!\" she said."
5. Which sentence shows rather than tells the reader a character is happy? A) Amir was happy. B) Amir felt joyful. C) Amir punched the air and laughed out loud. D) Amir was pleased about the news.

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6. Select ALL the sentences below that use onomatopoeia: A) The balloon popped loudly. B) The balloon was red. C) Thunder rumbled in the distance. D) The sky was cloudy.

7. Write a sentence using personification to describe a gentle breeze.

8. Which technique is used in "Peter Piper picked a peck of pickled peppers"? A) simile B) alliteration C) metaphor D) onomatopoeia

9. Explain why starting a sentence with "As the sun set," is more effective than "The sun was setting and she walked home."

10. Choose the better-written sentence and explain why: A) "The waves were big." B) "Waves crashed and thundered against the rocks."

11. Identify TWO techniques used in this sentence: "The wind howled like a wolf, tearing at her coat."

12. Which sentence opens with a prepositional phrase rather than the subject? A) Across the empty field, the fog crept. B) The fog crept across the empty field. C) The fog was thick. D) It crept across the field.

13. Select ALL the sentence openers below that add variety: A) Carefully, she opened the box. B) She opened the box carefully. C) With trembling hands, she opened the box. D) She opened the box with trembling hands.

14. Write a sentence that 'shows' a character is angry, without using the word 'angry'.

15. Identify the technique and explain why the writer chose it: "The volcano roared and spat fire at the sky."

Standard / Advanced (15 questions)

1. Identify the technique and its effect: "The gate groaned as it opened."

2. Identify the technique used in this sentence: "Her smile was sunshine itself."

3. Which sentence uses a metaphor (not a simile)? A) The classroom was as noisy as a zoo. B) The classroom was a zoo. C) The classroom sounded like a zoo. D) The classroom seemed like a zoo.

4. Explain the effect of the strong verb 'devoured' in: "The dog devoured its dinner."

5. Identify the technique in this sentence: "Thunder grumbled in the distance."

6. Rewrite this 'telling' sentence as a 'showing' one: "The old man was tired."

7. Select ALL the sentences below that use onomatopoeia. A) The fire crackled and hissed. B) The fire was hot. C) The tyres screeched to a stop. D) The car was fast.

8. Which sentence combines a simile AND personification? A) The wind howled like a wolf and tore at the trees. B) The wind was strong and cold. C) The wind blew against the window. D) The wind felt icy on her skin.

9. Choose the better-written sentence and explain why: A) "The classroom was messy and loud." B) "Chairs lay overturned and voices clashed like cymbals."

10. A paragraph reads: "The storm was loud. The storm was scary. Everyone was frightened." Rewrite it as 2-3 sentences using at least one strong verb and one technique (simile, metaphor or personification).

11. Identify the technique used in "Time crept by" and explain its effect.

12. Which sentence opens with a subordinate clause for variety? A) Because the rain was heavy, the match was cancelled. B) The match was cancelled because the rain was heavy. C) The rain was heavy and the match was cancelled. D) The match, because of rain, was cancelled.

13. Write one sentence describing a battlefield using personification, and one sentence describing it using a metaphor.

14. Select ALL the sentences below that use a strong, precise verb instead of 'went'. A) She dashed towards the exit. B) She went towards the exit. C) He trudged through the mud. D) He went through the mud.

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15. Explain the difference in effect between these two sentences: A) "The old man was sad and lonely." B) "The old man sat alone at the window, watching families pass by outside."

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